

Comparative analysis — community go-to stack vs Helper

What players are actually told to install, with GitHub evidence where it exists

This pack is a snapshot, not a ranking contest. Numbers are GitHub asset download counts on the latest listed release unless noted. Those counts are not unique users: Nexus auto-update re-downloads the DLL; CEF/catalog zips count first helper opens more than daily actives. Closed-source addons without a public release API are listed without download figures. No single score is used. Hyperbole from earlier canvases in this workspace is not reused.

“All other GW2 addons” is not enumerable here. Nexus, Blish, and ArcDPS plugin lists contain hundreds of modules. This document covers (a) the usual go-to stack, (b) the closest Nexus-era suites, (c) a category map so smaller addons are not pretended away. Download counts are latest-release GitHub assets on 2026-08-18 unless noted.

1. How the community go-to list was built

Criteria: what organized PvE/WvW players are still told to install in 2025–2026; what has a large observed download or is a loader everything else needs; what shows up in Raidcore/Nexus and Blish default advice. This is **not** an engineering ranking. ArcDPS belongs here even if its process model would score poorly on an enterprise rubric.

2. Community go-to top 10

#	Addon	Role	Evidence used here
1	Raidcore Nexus	d3d11.dll addon host. Loads Helper, Codex, CTK, Discordant, Map Completion, etc.	Latest tag v2026.2.17.900 d3d11.dll · 4,038 downloads. Understates lifetime use (older tags, Raidcore installer).
2	ArcDPS	Combat meter, skill/boon tracking via Present/d3d hook. De facto raid parse.	deltaconnected/arc dps is not a public GitHub releases API (404). Rank is from universal raid usage, not a download count.
3	Blish HUD	Out-of-process C# overlay + module SDK (pathing, markers, many QoL modules).	blish-hud/Blish-HUD v1.3.0 zip · 153,077 downloads. Still the largest public overlay platform even as Nexus grows.
4	GW2Radial	Hold-to-radial for mounts, novelty, markers. Small, focused.	Friendly0Fire/GW2Radial v2.4.0 zip · 228,562. Highest GitHub asset count in this pull.
5	Commander's Toolkit	Squad, marker, and commander QoL on Nexus.	RaidcoreGG/GW2-CommandersToolkit v2026.6.14.795 · 22,367 dll downloads.
6	ArcDPS Boon Table	Boon uptime table as an ArcDPS plugin.	knoxfighter/GW2-ArcDPS-Boon-Table 3.1.0 · 20,533.
7	Unofficial extras / food-utility reminders	Consumable and ArcDPS extras. Several forks; names vary by year.	No single canonical GitHub release in this pull. Listed because raid groups still require a reminder of this class.
8	Pathing stack (TacO and/or Blish Pathing)	Tekkit-format .taco markers. TacO is the historical viewer; Blish Pathing is the common modern host.	Format ecosystem, not one binary. Helper also consumes .taco packs (Tekkit permission documented).
9	Elite Insights + dps.report / wingman	EVTC decode and log upload. Usually not Nexus-injected.	Industry tool for raid review. Helper can download EI CLI (SHA-256) and parse locally — it does not replace EI.
10	Killproof.me (site + overlays/modules)	KP/li/title lookup for squads.	Helper KillProof tab is a public-profile WinHTTP client, not the site. Blish/Nexus modules also cover this.

Honorable frequent installs not squeezed into 10: ReShade, Overlay, ArcDPS mechanics/healer tables, food reminder forks, GW2-TrueWorldCompletion (1,044), MapCompletionTracker (1,046).

3. Where Helper sits against that list

Helper is **not** on the community go-to list. Evidence: repo age one month; latest DLL 585 downloads vs Radial 228k / Blish 153k / CTK 22k / Boon Table 20k; 2 stars. It also does not replace items 1–6. It overlaps 8–10 in part (pathing packs, EI CLI, kp.me public API) and adds account/API/browser surfaces those tools do not have.

Go-to item	Helper relationship
Nexus	Required host. Helper is a Nexus addon, not a competitor.
ArcDPS	COMPLIANCE.md forbids Present hooks so they can co-exist. No DPS meter in Helper. Dual-load smoke is documented, not automated in CI.
Blish HUD	Different process model. Overlap: pathing, some account/QoL. Blish remains the module platform with the large catalog. Helper is a single DLL suite + CEF, not a module host.
GW2Radial	No radial. Complementary.
Commander's Toolkit	No squad marker/commander feature parity claimed in this review. Complementary for raid leads.
Boon Table	No in-combat boon table. Complementary.
Food reminders	Raid food HTML/live panel exists; that is not the same as an ArcDPS combat reminder.
Pathing / TacO	Helper hosts curated .taco + optional PathingLua + world GPS ribbons. It is another viewer, not the format owner.
Elite Insights	Optional CLI under addons/.../ei/. Helper log pad parses output; EI remains the decoder.
Killproof.me	Read-only public profiles, in-memory cache. No kp.me login.

4. Closest-era Nexus suites (not the go-to 10)

Addon	Latest GitHub DLL (this pull)	What it is	Vs Helper
Tyrian Codex	v1.1.0.3 TyrianCodex.dll 439 · plus ~670 MB of .pack on that release (items 350, skins 344, tc-core 547, ...)	In-game item/skin/map encyclopedia with a multi-pack content pipeline.	Codex wins on shipped art volume. Helper wins on account/API/browser/pathing/logs. They are not the same product. Codex pack architecture is the reason Helper stayed single-DLL + catalog split rather than a dozen content packs.
Map Completion Tracker	v1.5.2 · 1,046 · 1.8 MB	Focused map completion.	Helper has a completion domain (~1.9k LOC) but this addon is smaller, older in the niche, and has more GitHub DLL downloads than Helper.
True World Completion	v6.0.8 · 1,044 · 1.1 MB	World completion tracker, long-lived.	Same pattern: focused tool, more downloads, less surface.
Discordant	v0.9.3.0 · 157 · 1.6 MB	Discord-in-GW2 attempt on Nexus.	Ambitious social embed. Helper documents that Discord OAuth often fails in CEF and routes some video to Open Ext. Discordant's download count is in the same “early Nexus experiment” band as Helper, slightly lower on the latest DLL.

5. Category map (so “all addons” is not a fake table)

Category	Typical addons	Helper coverage
Loader / host	Nexus, Blish (self-hosted overlay), legacy d3d9 chain	None — consumes Nexus.
Combat parse	ArcDPS, healer/boon/mechanics plugins	None in combat. Post-combat log pad + EI.
Input QoL	GW2Radial, camera/filter tools	PanelBinds (addon chords). Map assist opt-in. No radial.
Squad / commander	Commander's Toolkit, marker tools	Not CTK. Pathing markers are PvE trails, not squad marker UI.
Pathing	TacO, Blish Pathing, pack authors (Tekkit, Lady Elyssa, ...)	Viewer + GPS + optional Lua. Pack content is third-party.

Category	Typical addons	Helper coverage
Account / API	Blish modules, gw2efficiency/gw2.app (websites), Helper	Large: wallet, vault, unlocks, progress, TP watch, crafting, lookup. Hits ArenaNet from the PC.
Wiki / browser	Overlay browsers, Helper CEF	Core differentiator. Private CEF 150 OSR.
Item encyclopedia	Tyrian Codex, wiki	Catalog names/icons + lookup. Not Codex-scale renders.
Completion	Map Completion, True World Completion, Blish	Present, not the specialist.
Social	Discordant, overlays	Open Ext / documented OAuth limits.
Graphics	ReShade, Overlay, Nvidia/AMD overlays	Forbidden Present hooks; dual-load note only.
Linux / Proton	Wine-specific patches, Helper Watch	Watch + Wine TLS notes exist. High operational risk; not a Proton certification.

6. Size and install-cost comparison

Product	Player-facing payload (order of magnitude)	Notes
GW2Radial zip	3.9 MB	Focused.
Commander's Toolkit dll	0.9 MB	Focused.
Boon Table dll	13.3 MB	ArcDPS plugin.
Nexus d3d11.dll	7.3 MB	Host.
Blish HUD zip	15.4 MB	Plus .NET runtime on the machine.
Helper DLL	18.7 MB	Then CEF 167 MB once, catalog names ~8 MB, icons 126 MB if fetched, optional EI zip.
Tyrian Codex	DLL 6.3 MB + packs adding up to hundreds of MB on the latest release	Content-heavy by design.
Map / TWC	~1–2 MB	Specialists.

Helper's first-open cost is closer to Codex than to Radial. That is a product fact, not a defect by itself.

7. Comparative conclusions (no crown)

- On popularity and “what to install for raids,” Helper is not in the conversation yet.
- On feature breadth inside one Nexus DLL, Helper is wider than Codex, Discordant, Map Completion, and TWC. Breadth is not quality, and 92k LOC in a month is a maintenance load.
- On combat, Helper is correctly absent. The go-to stack still starts with Nexus + ArcDPS + Radial + a boon table + CTK.
- On account/API, websites (gw2efficiency, gw2.app) remain faster because they pre-warm. Helper's API Check is now 5 ArenaNet probes; Live/account pads still depend on the player's path to api.guildwars2.com.
- On encyclopedia art, Codex is ahead. Helper's catalog split is the overlapping idea done as GitHub Releases rather than many named .pack files.
- On overlay platforms, Blish still has the module economy. Helper is a monolith suite, which is easier to install and harder to extend by third parties.